Nightreader: the sentences

Every sentence the page would say, for 13 places and nights, worked out from real figures on Tuesday November 10th 2026.

All wording is draft: it is yours to change. This is the second version, with your changes of November 10th. The points to check are numbered at the end, so you can reply by number. Places are named by Lightreader's rule, reaching 60 miles where no town lies within 25; where there is still none (Shetland, Scilly), the compass point alone.

A. Reading (RG1)

Tuesday November 10th into Wednesday: tonight, just after a new Moon.

11h 2m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:17 to 05:19, 11h 2m in all. The Moon stays down throughout.

The Moon

- New Moon, 3% lit. At new Moon the Moon lies between us and the Sun, so its lit side faces away from us.
- It stays below the horizon all night.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 17:28 to 01:12, and in view for 29m before and 1h 8m after that window. At its highest, at 21:20, it stands 40° up (four fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Mars is well placed from 01:21 to 06:38, and in view for 1h 5m before that. At its highest, at 06:28, it stands 54° up (five and a half fists) in the same direction as Saturn.

- Jupiter is well placed from 01:35 to 06:48, and in view for 1h 5m before that. At its highest, at 06:34, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Venus is low: in view from 06:12 to 06:59, at best 16° up (one and a half fists) in the south-east, between Wokingham and Yateley, at 06:59. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Leonids meteor shower: best on the night of November 17th. A fair year for this annual event: 5h 56m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around November 20th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: November 24th.
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids meteor shower: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year for this annual event: 8h 40m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids meteor shower: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year for this annual event: the Moon is up all night.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids meteor shower: best on the night of January 3rd. A good year for this annual event: 11h 36m of the night is Moon-free.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.

- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

B. Reading (RG1)

Tuesday November 17th into Wednesday: a first-quarter Moon that sets before midnight.

5h 56m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:10 to 05:29, 11h 19m in all. The Moon sets at 23:33; the sky is at its darkest after that.

The Moon

- First quarter, 55% lit. About half lit, and growing: the Moon is a quarter of the way round its monthly circuit.
- It is already up at sunset, and sets at 23:33 in the west-south-west, roughly over Thatcham.
- At its highest during the night, at 18:24, it stands 26° up (two and a half fists) in the south, roughly over Alton.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 17:00 to 00:43, and in view for 10m before and 1h 7m after that window. At its highest, at 20:51, it stands 39° up (four fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Mars is well placed from 01:10 to 06:49, and in view for 1h 5m before that. At its highest, at 06:13, it stands 53° up (five and a half fists) in the same direction as Saturn.

- Jupiter is well placed from 01:11 to 06:59, and in view for 1h 5m before that. At its highest, at 06:09, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Venus is well placed from 07:01 to 07:10, and in view for 1h 22m before that. At its highest, at 07:10, it stands 21° up (two fists) in the south-east, between Crowthorne and Fleet (near Milford).
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

Looking ahead

- Leonids meteor shower: best tonight. A fair year for this annual event: 5h 56m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around November 20th (Friday), when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: November 24th.
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids meteor shower: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year for this annual event: 8h 40m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids meteor shower: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year for this annual event: the Moon is up all night.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids meteor shower: best on the night of January 3rd. A good year for this annual event: 11h 36m of the night is Moon-free.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.

- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

C. Reading (RG1)

Tuesday November 24th into Wednesday: a full Moon, up all night.

No Moon-free night

The Moon is up for the whole of true night

True night runs from 18:04 to 05:38, 11h 35m in all. The Moon is up throughout.

The Moon

- Full Moon, 100% lit. The whole face is lit: the Moon is opposite the Sun, so it rises around sunset and sets around sunrise.
- It is up all night.
- At its highest during the night, at 00:11, it stands 65° up (six and a half fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 16:43 to 00:14, and in view for 1h 8m after that. At its highest, at 20:23, it stands 39° up (four fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Jupiter is well placed from 00:46 to 07:10, and in view for 1h 5m before that. At its highest, at 05:43, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Mars is well placed from 00:59 to 06:59, and in view for 1h 5m before that. At its highest, at 05:57, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the same direction as Saturn.

- Venus is well placed from 06:39 to 07:21, and in view for 1h 21m before that. At its highest, at 07:21, it stands 24° up (two and a half fists) in the south-south-east, between Yateley and Fleet (near Milford).
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

Looking ahead

- Full Moon: today (November 24th).
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids meteor shower: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year for this annual event: 8h 40m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids meteor shower: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year for this annual event: the Moon is up all night.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids meteor shower: best on the night of January 3rd. A good year for this annual event: 11h 36m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best evenings for Mercury: around February 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

D. Reading (RG1)

Wednesday December 2nd into Thursday: a Moon that rises during the night.

7h 45m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:00 to 05:48, 11h 48m in all. The Moon rises at 01:44; the sky is at its darkest before that.

The Moon

- Last quarter, 32% lit. About half lit, and shrinking: the Moon is three-quarters of the way round its monthly circuit.
- It rises at 01:44 in the east, between Windsor and Wokingham (near North Ascot), and is still up at sunrise.
- At its highest during the night, at 07:27, it stands 32° up (three fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 16:38 to 23:41, and in view for 1h 8m after that. At its highest, at 19:51, it stands 39° up (four fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Jupiter is well placed from 00:16 to 07:21, and in view for 1h 4m before that. At its highest, at 05:13, it stands 52° up (five fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Mars is well placed from 00:43 to 07:10, and in view for 1h 4m before that. At its highest, at 05:38, it stands 51° up (five fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Venus is well placed from 06:28 to 07:32, and in view for 1h 22m before that. At its highest, at 07:32, it stands 26° up (two and a half fists) in the south-south-east, between Yateley and Fleet.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

Looking ahead

- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids meteor shower: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year for this annual event: 8h 40m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids meteor shower: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year for this annual event: the Moon is up all night.
- Full Moon: December 24th.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids meteor shower: best on the night of January 3rd. A good year for this annual event: 11h 36m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best evenings for Mercury: around February 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

E. Reading (RG1)

Sunday February 14th into Monday: Jupiter and Mars at their best.

2h 14m

of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 19:09 to 05:26, 10h 17m in all. The Moon sets at 03:12; the sky is at its darkest after that.

The Moon

- First quarter, 58% lit. About half lit, and growing: the Moon is a quarter of the way round its monthly circuit.
- It is already up at sunset, and sets at 03:12 in the north-west, between Didcot and Wallingford.
- At its highest during the night, at 18:19, it stands 64° up (six and a half fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).

The planets

- Jupiter is well placed from 18:55 to 05:09, and in view for 1h 5m before and 1h 4m after that window. At its highest, at 00:02, it stands 54° up (five and a half fists) in the south, between Bordon and Alton (near Hook).
- Saturn is well placed from 17:52 to 19:13, and in view for 1h 7m after that. At its highest, at 17:52, it stands 31° up (three fists) in the south-west, between Whitchurch and Tadley (near Burghfield Common).
- Mars is well placed from 19:46 to 05:53, and in view for 1h 4m before and 1h after that window. At its highest, at 00:50, it stands 53° up (five and a half fists) in the same direction as Jupiter.
- Venus is low: in view from 06:47 to 07:03, at best 11° up (one fist) in the south-south-east, between Yateley and Fleet (near Milford), at 07:03. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Mars at its best: February 19th (Friday), when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Full Moon: February 20th (Saturday).
- New Moon: March 8th.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around March 17th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Lyrids meteor shower: best on the night of April 22nd. A poor year for this annual event: only 22m of the night is Moon-free.
- Eta Aquariids meteor shower: best on the night of May 6th. A very good year for this annual event: no Moon at all.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.

F. Reading (RG1)

Monday June 21st into Tuesday: the shortest night: no true night.

No Moon-free night

True night is not reached tonight

The sky is "very dark" from 23:26 to 02:45, 3h 19m in all. The Moon is up throughout.

The Moon

- Waning gibbous, 92% lit. “Gibbous” means more than half lit; “waning” means shrinking, night by night, after full.
- It rises at 23:16 in the south-east, between Wokingham and Crowthorne (near Bagshot), and is still up at sunrise.
- At its highest during the night, at 03:35, it stands 18° up (two fists) in the south, roughly over Alton.

The planets

- Jupiter is low: in view from 21:58 to 22:58, at best 19° up (two fists) in the west, roughly over Hungerford, at 21:58. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mars is well placed from 22:13 to 22:38, and in view for 1h 6m after that. At its highest, at 22:13, it stands 24° up (two and a half fists) in the west-south-west, between Tadley and Thatcham.
- Saturn is low: in view from 03:08 to 03:59, at best 18° up (two fists) in the east, between Windsor and Wokingham (near North Ascot), at 03:59. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, below the horizon all night.
- Venus: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- New Moon: July 4th.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around July 15th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: July 18th.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- Perseids meteor shower: best on the night of August 12th. A fair year for this annual event: 2h 2m of the night is Moon-free.

- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.
- Jupiter at its best: March 12th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Best evenings for Venus: around March 22nd, when it is furthest from the Sun.

G. Edinburgh (EH1)

Tuesday November 10th into Wednesday: tonight, further north.

11h 7m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:24 to 05:31, 11h 7m in all. The Moon stays down throughout.

The Moon

- New Moon, 3% lit. At new Moon the Moon lies between us and the Sun, so its lit side faces away from us.
- It stays below the horizon all night.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 17:53 to 01:05, and in view for 57m before and 1h 17m after that window. At its highest, at 21:29, it stands 35° up (three and a half fists) in the south, between Loanhead and Penicuik.
- Mars is well placed from 01:30 to 06:59, and in view for 1h 12m before that. At its highest, at 06:37, it stands 49° up (five fists) in the same direction as Saturn.

- Jupiter is well placed from 01:46 to 07:10, and in view for 1h 12m before that. At its highest, at 06:43, it stands 48° up (five fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Venus is low: in view from 06:42 to 07:22, at best 14° up (one and a half fists) in the south-east, between Dalkeith and Bonnyrigg (near Gorebridge), at 07:22. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Leonids meteor shower: best on the night of November 17th. A fair year for this annual event: 6h 11m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around November 20th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: November 24th.
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids meteor shower: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year for this annual event: 9h of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids meteor shower: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year for this annual event: the Moon is up all night.
- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids meteor shower: best on the night of January 3rd. A very good year for this annual event: no Moon at all.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:11 to 10:52. At 10:00 the Moon covers 27% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.

- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 36° up.

H. Edinburgh (EH1)

Monday June 21st into Tuesday: the shortest night in Edinburgh: only "dark".

42m
of Moon-free "dark" night
("Very dark" and true night are not reached tonight.)

The sky is "dark" from 23:05 to 03:24, 4h 19m in all. The Moon rises at 23:47; the sky is at its darkest before that.

The Moon

- Waning gibbous, 92% lit. "Gibbous" means more than half lit; "waning" means shrinking, night by night, after full.
- It rises at 23:47 in the south-east, roughly over Dalkeith, and is still up at sunrise.
- At its highest during the night, at 03:44, it stands 13° up (one and a half fists) in the south, between Loanhead and Penicuik.

The planets

- Jupiter is low: in view from 22:45 to 23:13, at best 14° up (one and a half fists) in the west, between Broxburn and Queensferry (near Kirkliston), at 22:45. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mars is low: in view from 23:06 to 23:51, at best 16° up (one and a half fists) in the west-south-west, between Livingston and Broxburn (near Ratho), at 23:06. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, below the horizon all night.

- Venus: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.
- Saturn: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

Looking ahead

- New Moon: July 4th.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around July 15th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: July 18th.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:11 to 10:52. At 10:00 the Moon covers 27% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- Perseids meteor shower: best on the night of August 12th. A fair year for this annual event: 1h 33m of the night is Moon-free.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 36° up.
- Jupiter at its best: March 12th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Best evenings for Venus: around March 22nd, when it is furthest from the Sun.

I. Lerwick (ZE1)

Tuesday November 10th into Wednesday: tonight in Shetland: no towns in reach.

11h 12m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:13 to 05:25, 11h 12m in all. The Moon stays down throughout.

The Moon

- New Moon, 3% lit. At new Moon the Moon lies between us and the Sun, so its lit side faces away from us.
- It stays below the horizon all night.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 18:05 to 00:36, and in view for 1h 30m before and 1h 30m after that window. At its highest, at 21:21, it stands 31° up (three fists) in the south.
- Mars is well placed from 01:24 to 07:05, and in view for 1h 22m before that. At its highest, at 06:29, it stands 45° up (four and a half fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Jupiter is well placed from 01:41 to 07:18, and in view for 1h 21m before that. At its highest, at 06:35, it stands 44° up (four and a half fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Venus is low: in view from 07:01 to 07:32, at best 13° up (one and a half fists) in the south-east, at 07:32. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Leonids meteor shower: best on the night of November 17th. A fair year for this annual event: 6h 28m of the night is Moon-free.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around November 20th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: November 24th.
- New Moon: December 9th.
- Geminids meteor shower: best on the night of December 14th. A fair year for this annual event: 9h 25m of the night is Moon-free.
- Ursids meteor shower: best on the night of December 22nd. A poor year for this annual event: the Moon is up all night.

- Best mornings for Venus: around January 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids meteor shower: best on the night of January 3rd. A very good year for this annual event: no Moon at all.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:23 to 10:47. At 10:05 the Moon covers 15% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th 2027, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 34° up.

J. Sandwick (ZE2)

Monday June 21st into Tuesday: the shortest night in the north of Shetland.

No Moon-free night

"Very dark" and true night are not reached tonight

The sky is "dark" from 00:35 to 01:39, 1h 4m in all. The Moon is up throughout.

The Moon

- Waning gibbous, 92% lit. "Gibbous" means more than half lit; "waning" means shrinking, night by night, after full.
- It rises at 00:09 in the south-east, and is still up at sunrise.

The planets

- Mercury: not in view tonight, below the horizon all night.
- Venus: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.
- Mars, Jupiter and Saturn: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

Looking ahead

- New Moon: July 4th.
- Best mornings for Mercury: around July 15th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: July 18th.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:24 to 10:47. At 10:05 the Moon covers 15% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- Perseids meteor shower: best on the night of August 12th. A good year for this annual event: 3h 14m of the night is Moon-free.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 34° up.
- Jupiter at its best: March 12th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Best evenings for Venus: around March 22nd, when it is furthest from the Sun.

K. Penzance (TR18)

Sunday January 3rd into Monday: Venus at its best in the morning; the Quadrantids.

11h 26m

of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 18:31 to 06:22, 11h 51m in all. The Moon rises at 05:57; the sky is at its darkest before that.

The Moon

- Waning crescent, 13% lit. A crescent is less than half lit; “waning” means shrinking, night by night, towards new.
- It rises at 05:57 in the south-east, and is still up at sunrise.
- At its highest during the night, at 08:20, it stands 11° up (one fist) in the south-south-east.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 17:11 to 22:01, and in view for 1h 5m after that. At its highest, at 18:04, it stands 41° up (four fists) in the south.
- Jupiter is well placed from 22:24 to 07:53, and in view for 1h 2m before that. At its highest, at 03:23, it stands 54° up (five and a half fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Mars is well placed from 23:34 to 07:42, and in view for 1h 3m before that. At its highest, at 04:20, it stands 51° up (five fists) in the same direction as Saturn.
- Venus is well placed from 07:26 to 08:04, and in view for 1h 42m before that. At its highest, at 08:04, it stands 22° up (two fists) in the south-south-east.
- Mercury: not in view tonight, below the horizon all night.

Looking ahead

- Best mornings for Venus: around now (January 3rd), when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Quadrantids meteor shower: best tonight. A good year for this annual event: 11h 26m of the night is Moon-free.

- New Moon: January 7th (Thursday).
- Full Moon: January 22nd.
- Best evenings for Mercury: around February 3rd, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Jupiter at its best: February 11th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Mars at its best: February 19th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 08:58 to 10:55. At 09:55 the Moon covers 47% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th 2028. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 38° up.

L. Caerdydd (CF10)

Thursday August 12th into Friday: the Perseids; a place shown by its Welsh name.

2h 2m
of Moon-free true night

True night runs from 23:09 to 03:27, 4h 19m in all. The Moon sets at 01:26; the sky is at its darkest after that.

The Moon

- Waxing gibbous, 84% lit. "Gibbous" means more than half lit; "waxing" means growing, night by night, towards full.
- It is already up at sunset, and sets at 01:26 in the south-west, roughly over Barry.

- At its highest during the night, at 21:57, it stands 11° up (one fist) in the south, between Bridgwater and Watchet.

The planets

- Saturn is well placed from 01:03 to 05:16, and in view for 1h 5m before that. At its highest, at 05:16, it stands 47° up (four and a half fists) in the south, between Burnham-on-Sea and Wiveliscombe (near Creech St Michael).
- Mercury, Venus and Jupiter: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.
- Mars: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.

Looking ahead

- Perseids meteor shower: best tonight. A fair year for this annual event: 2h 2m of the night is Moon-free.
- Full Moon: August 17th (Tuesday).
- New Moon: August 31st.
- Best evenings for Mercury: around September 24th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Orionids meteor shower: best on the night of October 21st. A poor year for this annual event: only 2h 14m of the night is Moon-free.
- Leonids meteor shower: best on the night of November 17th. A poor year for this annual event: only 43m of the night is Moon-free.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 37° up.
- Eclipse of the Sun: January 26th, from 15:35 to 17:55. At 16:48 the Moon covers 54% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- Jupiter at its best: March 12th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.

- Best evenings for Venus: around March 22nd, when it is furthest from the Sun.

M. Reading (RG1)

Sunday July 4th into Monday: a new Moon in summer: Moon-free, but only “very dark”.

3h 37m
of Moon-free “very dark” night
(True night is not reached tonight.)

The sky is “very dark” from 23:20 to 02:57, 3h 37m in all. The Moon stays down throughout.

The Moon

- New Moon, 1% lit. At new Moon the Moon lies between us and the Sun, so its lit side faces away from us.
- It is already up at sunset, and sets at 22:03 in the north-west, between Wantage and Wallingford (near Goring).

The planets

- Jupiter is low: in view from 21:56 to 22:12, at best 12° up (one fist) in the west, between Newbury and Wantage, at 21:56. It needs a clear horizon.
- Mars is low: in view from 22:10 to 23:03, at best 18° up (two fists) in the west-south-west, roughly over Thatcham, at 22:10. It needs a clear horizon.
- Saturn is well placed from 03:24 to 04:07, and in view for 1h 5m before that. At its highest, at 04:07, it stands 26° up (two and a half fists) in the east-south-east, between Bracknell and Wokingham (near Bagshot).
- Mercury: not in view tonight, too low while the sky is dark.
- Venus: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.

Looking ahead

- Best mornings for Mercury: around July 15th, when it is furthest from the Sun.
- Full Moon: July 18th.
- Eclipse of the Sun: August 2nd, from 09:03 to 10:58. At 09:59 the Moon covers 42% of the Sun. Looking at the Sun without proper protection is dangerous and should be avoided.
- New Moon: August 2nd.
- Perseids meteor shower: best on the night of August 12th. A fair year for this annual event: 2h 2m of the night is Moon-free.
- Saturn at its best: October 18th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Eclipse of the Moon: January 12th. At 04:13 the Earth's shadow covers 3% of the Moon, which is 35° up.
- Jupiter at its best: March 12th, when it is opposite the Sun, at its brightest and up all night.
- Best evenings for Venus: around March 22nd, when it is furthest from the Sun.

Points for John

1. The opening in summer, reworked from your notes. Where the Moon is up throughout (F, J): "No Moon-free night / True night is not reached tonight". Where some of it is Moon-free (H, M): "42m / of Moon-free "dark" night / ("Very dark" and true night are not reached tonight.)". Is that right?

2. What each Moon phase means, after its name: for example “Waning gibbous, 92% lit. “Gibbous” means more than half lit; “waning” means shrinking, night by night, after full.” All eight are drafts; seven show in these examples. The eighth: “Waxing crescent. A crescent is less than half lit; “waxing” means growing, night by night, towards full.”
3. A well-placed planet, as you suggested: “Saturn is well placed from 17:28 to 01:12, and in view for 29m before and 1h 8m after that window.” Lengths are written the site’s way (“29m”, “1h 8m”) rather than “33 minutes”: is that all right?
4. A direction already given isn’t repeated: “Mars … stands 54° up (five and a half fists) in the same direction as Saturn.” Does that read naturally?
5. Planets not in view for the same reason are listed together: “Mercury, Venus and Jupiter: not in view tonight, too close to the Sun.” (L)
6. Meteor showers: “Perseids meteor shower: best tonight. A fair year for this annual event: 2h 2m of the night is Moon-free.” I added “meteor shower” after the name, as “Perseids” alone doesn’t say what it is. All eight showers listed come every year.
7. Short spells no longer count: in view for less than 15 minutes, or well placed for less than three. Mercury on November 17th (three minutes) is now “not in view”.
8. Welsh names: where a district in Wales has two names the Welsh one is shown (L: Caerdydd). The towns named in directions are still English (“roughly over Barry”), as the town list has only English names. In Scotland, districts with a Gaelic name show the English one for now (Inverness, not Inbhir Nis): would you like Gaelic there too?
9. Trimming “Looking ahead”: not done yet, as you’d like to work on it together. It runs to 13 lines at its longest (A). My questions are in the message with this sheet.